

## **Game Testing Summary – *Lost Trance***

### **Functional Testing – Making Sure the Game Feels Right**

#### **Core Mechanics:**

Mask switching is the heart of the game, so we spent most of our time here.

In early builds, the mechanics technically worked—but they didn't *feel* right. Players sometimes died even though they switched masks correctly, simply because the world updated a fraction too late. That broke trust immediately.

We fixed this by tightening input handling and syncing visuals, collisions, and sound to update together. Once this was done, players stopped blaming the game and started blaming themselves—and that's exactly where a fair challenge should land.

#### **Menus & UI:**

The UI needed to disappear when not in use.

At first, our menus were visually interesting but distracting. Colors were too loud, and some players spent more time understanding the settings than playing the game.

We simplified the UI using a 60–30–10 color rule and reduced visual noise. Tabs for Audio and Controls became clearer, sliders felt more responsive, and control remapping became visual instead of text-heavy. After that, players stopped asking questions—and that was our success signal.

### **Regression Testing – When Fixes Create New Problems:**

Every time we fixed something, something else tried to break.

Improving mask switching once caused audio to trigger incorrectly. A UI animation fix introduced a tiny input delay. These weren't dramatic bugs, but they mattered in a fast game.

Regression testing became a habit: after every change, we replayed old levels to make sure nothing felt off. This saved us from shipping small issues that would have added up to frustration.

### **Ad-hoc & Exploratory Testing – Playing Like a Player, Not a Designer:**

This was the most revealing part.

We deliberately played the game “wrong”:

- Switching masks at bad times
- Rushing through levels
- Standing still and observing
- Trying to break puzzles instead of solving them

This showed us that players don’t always think the way designers expect. Some puzzles had accidental solutions, while others confused players simply because the visual cues weren’t strong enough.

We adjusted level layouts and visuals to reward experimentation without letting players skip the challenge entirely.

### **Final Reflection:**

Testing **Lost Trance** taught us that a game can work perfectly and still feel wrong.

Every test cycle pushed us to simplify, clarify, and respect the player’s emotional and mental load. Bugs were not easy to fix.

By the end of testing, the game didn’t just function—it **felt honest**.

And for a game about emotions and perception, that mattered more than anything else.